



Rattlesnake

You might be confused to hear the sound of a maraca shaking in the desert, but this isn't a musical instrument. If you step too close to a rattlesnake, it lifts and shakes its tail to make a buzzing sound. Rings of dead skin at the tip rattle as they knock against each other. This unsettling noise is a warning — it tells you the rattlesnake has powerful venom and wants to be left alone.

If an enemy doesn't listen to its threat, a rattlesnake bends its body into an S-shape, ready to strike. Inside its mouth are two long fangs filled with venom. The eastern diamondback rattlesnake is North America's most deadly snake.